

Talking on the move

- **What?** Cordless phone
- **Who?** Sony
- **Where and when?** Japan, 1980s

A prototype cordless phone was patented in the 1960s by former US Army radio operator George Sweigert. However, most of us had to wait until the 1980s, when Japanese company Sony introduced the first commercially available cordless phones to the market.



Cordless phone, 1993

Early cell phone

- **What?** Nokia 3210
- **Who?** Nokia
- **Where and when?** Finland, 1999

The Nokia 3210, launched in 1999, became one of the most popular and successful phones in history. Its inclusion of three games, changeable covers, and customizable ringtones, along with an affordable price, made it popular with teenagers. It became many people's first-ever cell phone.



Nokia 3210



Antenna

Satellite phone

- **What?** Globalstar GSP-1700
- **Who?** Iridium and Globalstar companies
- **Where and when?** UK, 1998/1999

A satellite phone connects to orbiting satellites, rather than ground-based towers. This means it can make a call from essentially anywhere in the world. Satellite phone services are not cheap, but they are invaluable in remote areas where landline or cell phone networks don't exist.

An early satellite phone

Hands-free wireless technology

- **What?** Bluetooth unit
- **Who?** Ericsson
- **Where and when?** Sweden, 1994

Devised in Sweden, Bluetooth is a way of exchanging data wirelessly. Using a special radio frequency to transmit data, it creates a short-range network. It connects with a phone to leave your hands free, or with your desktop computer so you don't need cables to transfer files.



Bluetooth headset

FAST FACTS

- Alexander Graham Bell recommended answering the telephone with the word "Ahoy."
- The number of cell phones in the world overtook the number of people in 2014.
- The Nokia tone for receiving SMS text messages is Morse code for "SMS."
- The first cells had to be charged for 10 hours to give 30 minutes of battery life.
- The 555 prefix is reserved for fictional US telephone numbers.

Early smartphone

- **What?** N-series
- **Who?** Nokia
- **Where and when?** Finland, 2005

When Nokia launched the N70, it introduced the world to a phone that could double up as a portable computer, camera, GPS, and music player. However, just two years later, Apple launched the iPhone—a touchscreen smartphone that dominated the market.

